

10: Fingerprints Sampling

Stat 120 | Spring 2026

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#l include: false

# Note: function written with gemini

library(magick)

#' Sample and Display Images
#'
#' @param image_paths A character vector of 3 image file paths or URLs
#' @param size The number of images to sample (e.g., 5 or 20)
#' @param probs A numeric vector of 3 probabilities
sample_fingerprints <- function(size = 5) {

  probs = c(0.08, 0.3, 0.62)

  image_paths <- c(
    "images/arch-green.png",
    "images/whorl-teal.png",
    "images/loop-purple.png"
  )

  # 1. Input Validation
  if(length(image_paths) != 3) {
    stop("Please provide exactly 3 image paths or URLs.")
  }
  if(length(probs) != 3 || sum(probs) != 1) {
    stop("Please provide exactly 3 probabilities that sum to 1.")
  }
  if(!size %in% c(5, 20)) {
    warning("This function was specifically designed for sizes 5 or 20, but will attempt to run")
  }
}
```

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# 2. Read the images into R
imgs <- c(
  image_read(image_paths[1]),
  image_read(image_paths[2]),
  image_read(image_paths[3])
)

# 3. Sample the indices based on the provided probabilities
sampled_indices <- sample(
  x = 1:3,
  size = size,
  replace = TRUE,
  prob = probs
)

# Print the text result to the console so you can verify the frequencies
# cat("Sampled sequence (Image Indices):\n")
# print(sampled_indices)

# 4. Extract the sampled images
sampled_imgs <- imgs[sampled_indices]

# 5. Format and display the images
# Scale them to be uniform squares so the grid looks neat
sampled_imgs <- image_scale(sampled_imgs, "200x200!")

# Determine the grid layout: 5 columns x 1 row (for 5) or 5 columns x 4 rows (for 20)
grid_layout <- ifelse(size == 5, "5x1", "5x4")

# Create a montage (grid) of the sampled images with a 2-pixel border spacing
img_grid <- image_montage(sampled_imgs, tile = grid_layout, geometry = "200x200+2+2")

# Display the final graphic in the RStudio Viewer
plot(as.raster(img_grid))
}

```

```
sample_fingerprints(size = 5)
```

i When you're done gathering your samples, input your sample statistics ($\hat{p}$) in this [google sheet](#). Make sure to record your answer as a decimal point (e.g. 0.8 instead of 80% or 8/10).